01 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Lead with a traceable model.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

Our worked example records 48 session events across 30 hypothetical workspaces. Fourteen workspaces appear more than once. That gives us a precise pattern to discuss, not a claim that we have customers, retained users or revenue. Relay Cards is a fictional concept, and every row in this example is invented.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> Keep the model label audible and visible. The complete 30-row source is downloadable. Workspace IDs are fictional identifiers, not actual people or client organisations.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Progress statement

30 invented workspaces produce 48 session events.

Model source

Complete authored rows in source CSV and JSON.

Evidence qualification

Synthetic activity is not observed business traction.

What exactly is counted, and is any of it observed?



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

02 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Define the unit before the headline.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

A workspace is the unit of the source row; a session count is the number assigned to that row. We should not call 48 events 48 users or 30 workspaces 30 paying accounts. The distinction is essential to making the progress conversation inspectable.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> The source contains 16 single-session rows, ten two-session rows and four three-session rows. It provides no identity resolution, payment information or time-based cohort definition.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Row unit

One row represents one invented workspace.

Event unit

A session event is not a person or account.

Unsupported relabelling

Do not relabel workspaces as customers or paying users.

What would be required to connect this unit to a real customer metric?



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

03 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Show the pattern without upgrading it.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

Sixteen hypothetical workspaces have one session, ten have two and four have three. The repeated-workspace count is therefore 14, and the event total is 16 plus 20 plus 12, or 48. This describes the invented table and nothing more.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> Display both the count and its source boundary. A returning workspace is not automatically a retained user, a satisfied customer or an independent organisation.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Distribution

16 single-session, 10 two-session, 4 three-session rows.

Reconciliation

16 + 20 + 12 = 48 model session events.

Interpretation boundary

Repetition alone does not establish a time trend.

Which inference reaches beyond what repeated appearances actually mean?



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

04 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Keep retention a question.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

Fourteen out of 30 is about 46.7% of the rows with more than one assigned session. We do not label that retention, because the example has no observation window or eligible cohort. A real retention claim would need those definitions before the percentage became meaningful.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> Do not turn a model fraction into a growth claim. Preserve the numerator, denominator, time-window gap and synthetic label beside any edited headline.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Numerator

14 workspaces have more than one session event.

Denominator

All 30 invented workspaces; approximately 46.7%.

Missing cohort rule

No cohort, eligibility rule or observation window supplied.

What observation period and eligibility rule would a retention metric require?



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

05 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Use growth language carefully.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

This source has no time series. It cannot tell us that activity grew, accelerated or became more efficient. What it can do is make clear which observations a real progress report would need to collect before discussing a trend.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> There are no dates, acquisition costs, sales stages or conversion paths in the invented rows. Do not manufacture a rising chart or causal explanation from the order of workspace IDs.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Trend claim to test

Whether comparable activity increases over defined periods.

Missing time source

Dated observations with stable definitions and coverage.

Permitted description

Describe the supplied distribution, not business growth.

What evidence would establish change over time rather than a static distribution?



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

06 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Say what is missing about revenue.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

The model supplies no prices, transactions, contracts or willingness-to-pay evidence. Session activity would not establish revenue even if the activity were real. Our commercial question remains who would pay for which outcome under what sustainable conditions.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> All paid-status fields are null, meaning not supplied rather than false or zero. Do not convert missing payment evidence into either zero revenue or proven monetisation.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Payment evidence

Every paid_status value is unknown, not false.

Missing commercial source

No invoices, payment records or revenue ledger provided.

Revenue boundary

Unknown payment is neither zero revenue nor confirmed revenue.

What separate evidence would support a real commercial claim?



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

07 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Connect a claim to a reviewer question.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

When we make a progress statement, the next line should identify how a reviewer could inspect it. If the source is incomplete or the definition changes, the statement should become narrower rather than more confident.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> Use the source export, a metric dictionary and a question log. The supplied table only demonstrates that structure; it is not a verified reporting system or evidence of real operating controls.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Claim

The synthetic register contains repeated session activity.

Reviewable artifact

The downloadable 30-row source register.

Definition question

What counts as a session, and over which period?

Could another reader reproduce the headline from the source?

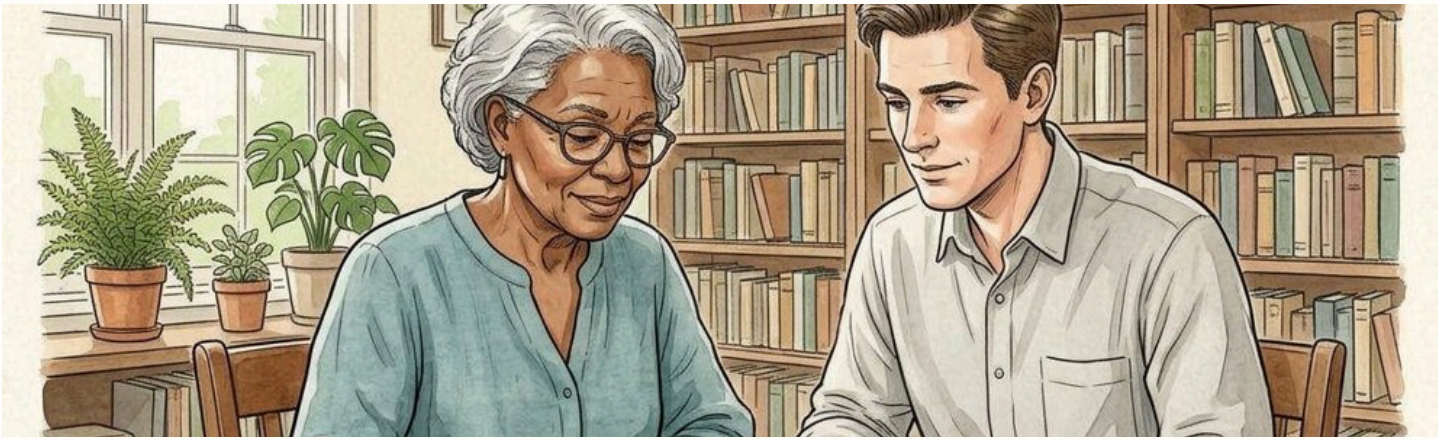


Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

08 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Turn the next milestone into a test.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

The next useful milestone would establish a real observation unit, an appropriate collection context and a reason that the resulting signal matters. It would not be a larger invented number. A milestone should make a decision easier, including the decision to change direction.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> No real test, participant recruitment or collection permission is supplied. A genuine plan needs suitable context and independent review before collecting or interpreting information.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Milestone question

Can an appropriately defined task produce interpretable observations?

Suitable observation

A bounded study with documented units and eligibility.

Stop-or-revise condition

Revise if the unit or observation cannot support the claim.

Which result would cause you to revise the current business hypothesis?

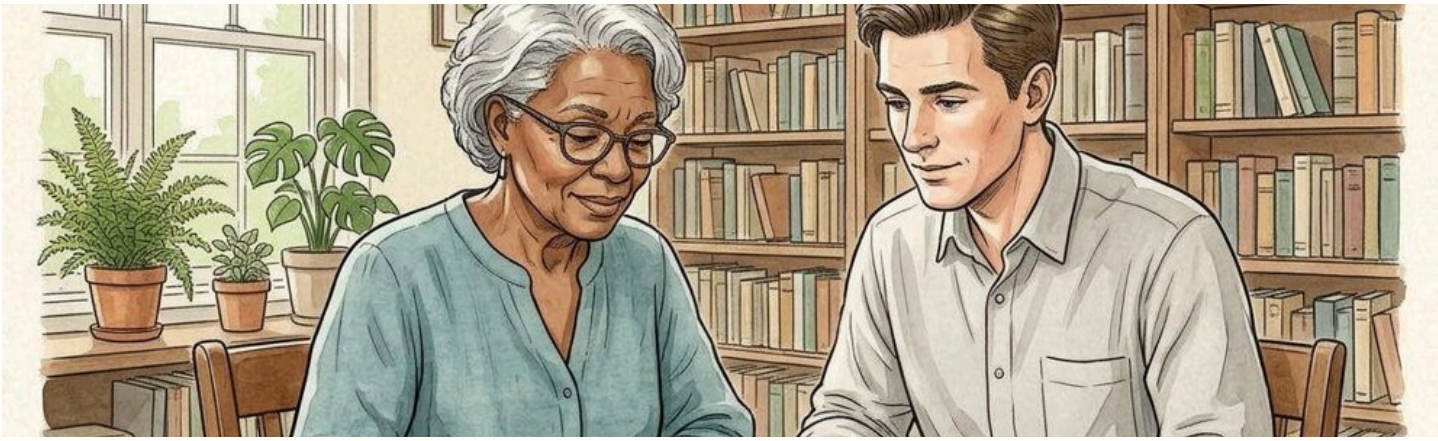


Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

09 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Tie resources to an evidence gap.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

A financing discussion should connect the proposed use of resources to the uncertainty it addresses. In this example, the unresolved gaps concern real demand, meaningful repeat use and commercial conditions. No funding amount, valuation, runway or agreed investment terms are supplied.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> Keep a real ask separate from teaching arithmetic. Do not infer an actual raise from the 48 model events, and do not label a request funded or committed without a confirmed source.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Resource purpose

Clarify definitions before expanding activity claims.

Evidence gap

Missing observation window, cohort rules and payment evidence.

Actual terms to establish

No actual investment amount, valuation or terms supplied.

What must be learned before a larger commitment is justified?



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

10 / TRACTION DIALOGUE

Invite verification, not belief.

ILLUSTRATIVE SPOKEN DRAFT

We want the progress conversation to be inspectable: what is counted, which source supports it and what remains unknown. If you want to continue, the next step is to agree which real evidence would be useful and who would need to review it.

SPEAKER / EVIDENCE NOTE — NOT A PERFORMANCE CLAIM

> Close with the metric boundary intact. The complete invented table accompanies the script; no real customer outcome, audited metric or investment offer is implied.

Keep the fictional status visible. Replace illustrative material only with appropriately sourced, verified information; proposed questions are not completed diligence.

Verification request

Recompute the totals and challenge the definitions.

Relevant source

Use the original CSV/JSON, not edited narrative as data.

Next discussion

Agree what real evidence would be appropriate to collect.

What source would you ask to inspect first?



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json